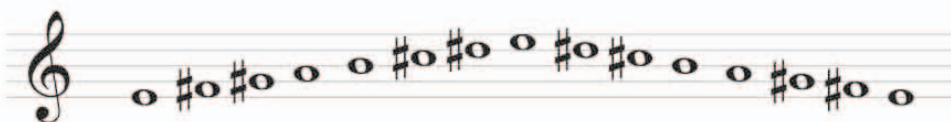


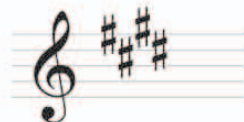
Keys and key signatures

Major and minor key signatures

Key signatures show the sharps or flats that are needed for a particular key. Major key signatures have the same sharps or flats as the key's major scale, while minor key signatures have the same sharps or flats as the key's natural minor scale.



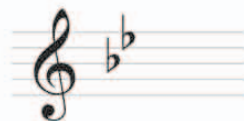
E major



E major key signature



G minor



G minor key signature

How key signatures are written

The sharps or flats of a key signature are written immediately after the clef, at the beginning of each line of music. Sharps and flats are always written in the same order, as shown below.



Sharps in a key signature

The sharps in a key signature are always written in this order: F#, then C#, followed by G#, D#, A#, E#, and finally B#.

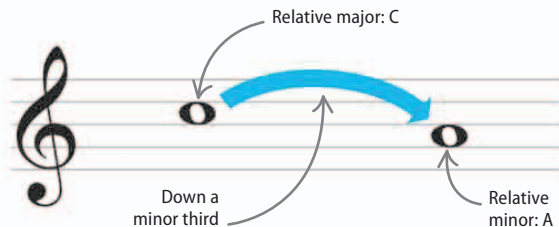


Flats in a key signature

The flats in a key signature are always written in this order: Bb, followed by Eb, then Ab, Db, Gb, and finally Cb.

Relative major and relative minor

All major keys have a relative minor key. The relative major and relative minor share the same key signature. The keynote of the relative minor is a minor third below the keynote of its relative major.



Relative minor keynote

A minor is the relative minor of C major. Its keynote, A, is a minor third below C, the keynote of C major.